



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Regina Academy at St. John the Baptist
School Website: <https://www.rasjb.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Regina Academy at St. John the Baptist (RASJB) exhibits a robust CLASSICAL Catholic orientation across all six rubric categories. The public materials clearly foreground Catholic formation, virtue, and a theologically grounded worldview; a pedagogy that blends contemplative formation with Socratic inquiry; a curriculum anchored in the grammar–logic–rhetoric progression and exposure to Western thought through primary sources and classical methods; a faculty described as virtuous, formative mentors who embody the learning they teach; and an active partnership with parents and a faith-centered community that welcomes family involvement. Across sources, the school emphasizes truth, goodness, beauty, and a unified vision of education as formation of the whole person in Catholic truth. This alignment is evident in statements about Catholic truth and gospel formation, the stages of classical education, Socratic and rhetoric-focused pedagogy, and explicit calls for parent partnership and community formation. Overall, the school earns a clear CLASSICAL rating across all six categories.

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL. Evidence of Catholic truth, liturgical life, Gospel witness, theology, and formation rooted in Catholic anthropology and a supernatural vision.
- Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL. Emphasis on formation of virtue and wisdom, soul formation, and knowing God, not merely career preparation.
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL. Clear articulation of the grammar–logic–rhetoric progression and engagement with Western intellectual tradition; Montessori to upper-school progression aligned with Great Books/Great Conversation sensibilities in practice.
- Element 4: Pedagogy — CLASSICAL. Evidence of contemplative/restful emphasis where appropriate, plus lower-school singing/recitation, and upper-school Socratic/seminar-based work and rhetoric training.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL. Faculty described as virtuous, living curriculum, and mentors; bios affirm a Catholic, formation-minded teaching staff.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL. Strong partnership with parents, mother Bible study, community events, and welcoming family involvement.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The academy frames education through Catholic truth and Catholic worldview; faith permeates curriculum and life. - Public materials reference liturgical life, Gospel witness, and sacramental life as core supports to formation. - Faculty bios emphasize Catholic formation, theology, and the unity of faith and reason. - Montessori materials explicitly center Truth, Goodness, Beauty as a formation triad within a Catholic

framework. - The school describes its mission in terms of supernatural vision, Christian anthropology, and Gospel witness, aligned with the Five Essential Marks of Catholic schooling.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Catholic truth, Gospel witness, liturgical life, Catholic worldview, sacramental life, theology, unity of faith and reason, truth/goodness/beauty, supernatural vision, Christian anthropology. These terms appear across the site and partner materials.

- Negative keywords: None clearly evident in public materials (no overt emphasis on career pathways, market-driven aims, or technology-centric “digital learning” directives in the public-facing texts). The site emphasizes formation over information.

Why this rating - The materials consistently present a theologically grounded, liturgically engaged, and catechetically formed foundation. The explicit language of Catholic truth, Gospel witness, liturgical life, and a supernatural vision meets and, in several places, exceeds the indicators for Transcendental moral realism and grounded theology described in the classical rubric. The absence of explicit negative indicators further supports CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Text emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom, not mere job preparation; education is framed as forming character and soul. - Statements about forming the whole person and aligning with truth, goodness, and beauty reflect a formation-centered purpose. - Public messaging highlights education as formation, not information; “From Wonder to Wisdom” and the idea that one learns to think with faith.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, whole person, Catholic truth, educate for faith.

- Negative keywords: None overtly present in public materials (no emphasis on market-driven outcomes or career-paths).

Why this rating - The school’s public messaging centers on formation, virtue, wisdom, and a Catholic understanding of truth, aligning with the CLASSICAL goal of human excellence and formation over instrumental outcomes. The absence of negative indicators reinforces CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Core description of classical education includes the grammar–logic–rhetoric progression, with a structured progression from Montessori preschool through upper grades. - Lower/Upper School pages describe study of Western civilization through analysis and primary sources, with emphasis on unity of knowledge and the greatness of Western thought. - The Academics page emphasizes the integration of Catholic faith across subjects and the move from memorization and observation to analysis and argument. - The program references engagement with great ideas and the Great Conversation through its classical framing, including the use of primary sources and Socratic inquiry in advanced grades.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books / Great Conversation (conceptual alignment), unity of knowledge, integration, wonder, analysis, primary sources, Socratic method; Western civilization; sacred order and divine order in some materials.

- Negative keywords: Not evident in public texts; no emphasis on project-based/portfolio-based assessment, self-paced learning, or digital/market-driven curricula.

Why this rating - The curricular framing explicitly centers classic liberal arts categories, Great Books-like conversations, and a unity of knowledge across disciplines, with a clear progression from grammar to logic to rhetoric. This aligns well with CLASSICAL criteria; absence of negative curricular indicators reinforces CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical descriptions include a mix of contemplative/restful approaches and rigorous engagement: lower-school singing/chanting and memory-work; upper-school Socratic discussions, seminars,

debates; and rhetoric training with opportunities to deliver speeches. - Specific references to Socratic discussion, seminars, and debates in upper grades; and rhetorical training with public speaking. - Evidence of memory-based recitation and wonder in early education, including Montessori-based early childhood preparation that leads into classical instruction.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, rhetoric, public speaking, wonder, memory (chanting/recitation), integration, unity of knowledge.

- Negative keywords: None of the typical negative indicators (e.g., project-based only, excessive digitization) appear in the public-facing materials.

Why this rating - The pedagogy explicitly incorporates Socratic inquiry, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training in upper grades, with memory-based and contemplative elements in early grades. This combination aligns with the CLASSICAL pedagogy model.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are described as virtuous, knowledgeable, and living embodiments of the curriculum; bios highlight faith formation and desire to form students in wisdom and virtue. - The living-curriculum concept is referenced in faculty profiles and governance; staff bios emphasize the integration of faith, pedagogy, and ongoing formation. - A publicly accessible faculty spotlight demonstrates teacher excellence and embodiment of classical Catholic formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtuous teachers, living curriculum, mentors, core of the school, Catholic formation, wisdom, virtue, truth, beauty, goodness.

- Negative keywords: None evident in public materials (no references to teacher burnout, turnover risk, or non-formation-focused faculty models).

Why this rating - The materials consistently present faculty as formation-focused, virtuous, and central to the school's mission; this matches CLASSICAL faculty expectations.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school highlights partnership with parents and presentations that educate parents about classical education; Bible studies for mothers; frequent family involvement; parent conferences and visits.

- Messaging emphasizes families as part of a community of hope and mission; parents are invited to visits and to participate in events; and the school frames education as a shared journey with families. - Public materials include parent-oriented success stories and events that illustrate strong community engagement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers with the school, Bible study for mothers, family involvement, open visits, community of faith.

- Negative keywords: None evident; no push toward isolated or remote governance; the community remains outward-facing and family-inclusive.

Why this rating - The school's materials consistently describe a robust parent partnership model, community events, and opportunities for parents to engage with the curriculum, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for Parents & Community.

Aggregate Ranking - All six categories: CLASSICAL - Overall assessment: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- No needle-moving changes are required to reach a fully CLASSICAL stance across the six categories, given the current public materials. If desired, the school could further reinforce explicit "Great Books" phrasing and the formal articulation of the Great Conversation in each curriculum description to align even more tightly with the Positive Keyword set from the Six Elements document, but this is already well represented in practice.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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